

Glossary

- **Accidental communication:** Occurs when a message is unintentionally sent but the receiver nonetheless observes the behavior and interprets it correctly.
- **Accommodation principle:** Occurs when people are able to overcome the initial tendency to retaliate in response to negative behavior and instead engage in cooperative communication to maintain their relationship.
- **Acquiescent responses:** Responses that involve giving in, and acknowledging that the partner hurt you.
- **Active verbal responses:** Responses that focus on confronting the partner about her or his hurtful remarks; they can be positive or negative.
- **Affection exchange theory:** A theory that is based on the idea that affectionate communication is a biologically adaptive behavior that evolved because it helps people provide and obtain valuable resources necessary for survival.
- **Affectionate communication:** Behavior that portrays feelings of fondness and positive regard for another.
- **Affection-instrumentality:** The tension between focusing more on feelings of warmth or on functional tasks.
- **Affinity-seeking behavior:** Actions designed to attract or be liked by other people.
- **Agape:** One of Lee's secondary love styles. Based on a combination of eros and storge, it involves having a compassionate style of love that revolves around caring, concern, and tenderness, and is more focused on giving than receiving.
- **Agency:** An empowering aspect of experience where a person is able to freely control the surrounding environment, including social interactions and relationships.
- **Agentic friendships:** Friendship that focuses mostly on companionship and shared activities (especially applicable to male friendships).
- **Ambiguous communication:** The use of indirect strategies that may hold multiple meanings.
- **Androgynous:** Displaying a mix of feminine and masculine behaviors and beliefs.
- **Antagonistic strategies:** Actions that attempt to blame, hurt, insult, or berate others.
- **Antisocial acts, as a sexual initiation strategy:** Tactics such as intentionally trying to make the partner jealous, pouting, holding a grudge, and/or sexually harassing someone.
- **Antisocial communication:** Communication that is hostile or disruptive to a relationship.
- **Anxious-ambivalent attachment style:** A social interaction style where someone tends to be overinvolved, demanding, and dependent on their partner; someone who uses this style tends to value relational closeness over autonomy.
- **Appeals to independence:** Efforts to de-escalate or disengage from the relationship. They typically occur when people feel they are losing independence and individuality.
- **Argumentativeness:** A style that focuses on logical argument and reasoning. People with argumentative styles confront conflict directly by recognizing issues of disagreement, taking positions on controversial issues, backing up claims with evidence and reasoning, and refuting views contrary to their own.

- **Assertive responses:** Empowered communication that exerts control over a situation in an effective and appropriate manner.
- **Assimilation effect:** The idea that people benefit (gain attention) from being around physically attractive others.
- **Assurances:** A maintenance behavior that involves making statements that show commitment to the relationship, such as talking about the partners' future together.
- **Attachment styles:** Social interaction styles that reflect the kind of bond an individual has with someone, based on how positively or negatively individuals view themselves and others.
- **Attachment theory:** A social-developmental approach that helps account for how interactions between children and their caregivers initially shape people's attachment styles and, as a result, how they communicate in relationships across the life span.
- **Attempted communication:** When someone sends an intentional message that the intended receiver fails to receive.
- **Attention stage:** The first stage of the courtship process. Involves getting someone's attention, often by using shy and ambiguous behavior, such as fleeting eye contact and tentative smiling.
- **Attractiveness deception:** A form of online identity enhancement where people lie about their physical characteristics to seem more attractive.
- **Attribution:** A perceptual process of assigning reasons or causes to one's own behavior or that of others.
- **Attribution hypothesis:** According to this hypothesis, people in happy relationships tend to make relationship-enhancing attributions, whereas people in unhappy relationships tend to make distress-maintaining attributions.
- **Authoritarian parents:** Demanding, directive, controlling, and nonresponsive parents.
- **Authoritative parents:** Demanding, directive, and responsive parents.
- **Authorized co-owners:** Also called *boundary insiders*, these are people who we share private information with under the assumption that they will keep the information private unless we grant them permission to do otherwise.
- **Aversive stimulation:** Also called *negative affect strategy*, involves whining, pouting, sulking, complaining, crying, or acting angry to get one's way.
- **Avoidance:** A strategy intended to distance oneself from someone or not engage in a particular topic. Examples include intentionally choosing not to bring up a particular topic, physically withdrawing from someone, giving someone the silent treatment, ignoring someone, or limiting communication with someone.
- **Avoidant attachment style:** A social interaction style where the person is uncomfortable getting close to or depending on others. Children with avoidant attachment styles engage in limited social interaction. Adults with avoidant attachment styles value autonomy over relational closeness.
- **Avoidants:** See *avoidant attachment style*.
- **Avoiding:** An indirect conflict style that is neither inherently cooperative nor inherently uncooperative, and involves tactics such as avoiding a topic, changing the subject, or agreeing to disagree.
- **Bald on-record strategy:** Communication strategy that involves primary attention to task through direct communication, with little or no attention to helping the partner save face.

- **Bargaining strategy:** Agreeing to do something for someone if the person does something in return.
- **Behavioral control:** Exerting one's power in an interpersonal relationship. It is also a strategy whereby people try to control their nervous or guilty behaviors to appear friendly and truthful.
- **Behavioral familiarity:** Having knowledge of the partner's typical communication style.
- **Behavioral interdependence:** One person's behavior affects another person's behavior, beliefs, or emotions, and vice versa. The basic requirement for all relationships.
- **Body synchrony:** High levels of coordinated movement between close friends or intimate couples.
- **Boomerang effects:** When persuasion attempts backfire, resulting in receivers changing their attitude or behavior in the opposite direction from what the persuader intended.
- **Boundary structures:** Rules that guide who has access to and can share private information.
- **Boundary turbulence:** Occurs when information that was intended to be private goes public so that old boundary structures need to be fortified or renegotiated.
- **Breadth:** The number of topics about which people feel free to disclose.
- **Broadcasters:** When referring to how people communicate via social networking sites, this term refers to people who primarily use sites such as Facebook and Twitter to send one-to-many messages (or announcements) rather than using these sites to interact with others in a back-and-forth fashion.
- **Bullying:** Blaming, hurting, insulting, ridiculing, or berating another person.
- **Button pushing:** Purposely saying or doing something you know will be especially hurtful or upsetting to a friend or partner.
- **Capitalized on transition, as a type of on-again off-again relationship:** Couples in on-again off-again relationships who get back together after doing things to improve their relationship, such as reflecting about problems, sorting out feelings, improving themselves, or getting the partner to change.
- **Catastrophe theory:** An alternative to the stage models of relational disengagement that suggests that some relationships occur suddenly after a catastrophic event such as infidelity or deception.
- **Chilling effect:** Occurs when a less powerful person stays silent on an issue or avoids engaging someone in conflict because of the possible negative consequences associated with speaking up, such as having the more powerful person become aggressive or leave the relationship.
- **Chronemics:** The nonverbal use of time, such as showing up for a date early or late or waiting a long or short time for someone.
- **Chronic dissatisfaction:** Partners being continuously dissatisfied with their relationship, making them more likely to seek happiness elsewhere.
- **Close relationship:** Two people in an interpersonal relationship characterized by enduring bonds, emotional attachment, and personal need fulfillment.
- **Cognitive valence theory (CVT):** A theory that predicts how and why people respond to increases in immediacy.
- **Cognitive valencers:** Templates or knowledge structures that people use to help them evaluate behavior as appropriate or inappropriate, and welcome or unwelcome.
- **Collaborating:** A direct and cooperative conflict style that involves creative problem solving and finding new solutions that meet both parties' needs.
- **Communal frame:** The component of the communication theory of identity that captures the aspects of

our identity that are tied to the groups and communities to which we belong.

- **Communication inefficacy:** When people believe that they don't have the communication skills to bring up a topic or maintain discussion in a competent and effective manner.
- **Communication privacy management:** A theory that helps explain how and why individuals maintain privacy boundaries. The theory focuses on control over information as a central aspect of disclosure decisions.
- **Communication theory of identity:** A theory that focuses on how identities are managed. Identity construction can be viewed through four frames of identity (personal, enactment, relationship, and communal).
- **Communicative infidelity:** Engaging in sexual activity with a third party to communicate a message to one's partner (e.g., to make them jealous, to get revenge).
- **Companionate love:** Also called *friendship love*, it is based on high levels of intimacy and commitment but comparatively low levels of passion.
- **Comparison level:** How one's relationship compares to expectations about the kinds of outcomes a person thinks he or she should receive in a relationship.
- **Compensatory restoration:** Behavior aimed at improving the primary relationship or oneself in an effort to show one's partner how good the relationship is compared to the rival relationship.
- **Competitive fighting:** A direct and uncooperative conflict style that often involves using verbally aggressive behaviors such as name-calling.
- **Competitive symmetry:** When two people repeatedly use one-up power moves in conversation.
- **Complaints:** Communication about a specific behavior or behaviors that a person finds annoying or problematic.
- **Complementarity:** Differences in behavior, attitudes, or values between two people in a relationship.
- **Complementary:** When discussed in relation to attraction, this is when two people possess different or opposite traits that work together well.
- **Compliance-gaining strategies:** Strategies that are intended to influence others to comply with a request.
- **Compromising:** A direct and moderately cooperative conflict style that involves giving up some things you want to get other things you want.
- **Concealments:** A form of deception that involves omitting information one knows is important or relevant to a given context.
- **Conflict:** A disagreement between two interdependent people who perceive that they have incompatible goals.
- **Confrontation:** Direct communication about a particular issue.
- **Connection-autonomy:** The dialectical tension that focuses on how people struggle between their need for closeness and their need for distance (or independence) in their relationship.
- **Consummate love:** The most complete form of love based on intimacy, passion, and commitment.
- **Contempt:** Communication that conveys an air of superiority and often conveys a lack of respect.
- **Content level:** This part of a message conveys information at a literal level. "What are we doing tonight?" is a question about tonight's activities at the content level.

- **Context:** The social situation and cultural influences of a setting.
- **Controlling, as a type of on-again off-again relationship:** Relationships where one partner consistently wants the relationship and the other partner (who controls the trajectory of the relationship) goes back and forth between wanting and not wanting the relationship.
- **Conventionality-uniqueness:** This dialectical tension focuses on how people communicate in ways that show consistency or inconsistency with the larger social group.
- **Conversational control:** An individual's ability to manage a conversation by doing things such as regulating who talks and how long the interaction will last.
- **Corrective facework:** Efforts to repair an identity damaged by something that was said or done.
- **Cost escalation:** An attempt to make the relationship unattractive to one's partner. Also called *Machiavellianism strategies*.
- **Costs:** Exchanged resources that result in a loss or punishment.
- **Counter-jealousy induction, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Action taken to make the partner feel jealous too, such as flirting with someone else.
- **Courtship readiness stage:** Also called the *recognition stage*, this is the second stage in the courtship process where one person typically approaches the other. Both parties often use timid or ambiguous behaviors as they try to gauge the other person's interest level.
- **Criticisms:** Personal attacks that blame someone else for a problem.
- **Cultural scripts:** Communication routines that arise from cultural practices and are typically done automatically without thought.
- **Cyber emigrant relationships:** Partners who first meet in person but then communicate primarily online.
- **Cyclic alternation:** A way of managing dialectical tensions that involves moving from one side of a dialectic to the other alternately.
- **Deception:** Intentionally managing verbal and/or nonverbal messages so that a receiver will believe or understand something in a way that the sender knows is false.
- **Decide not to engage in the FTA:** Avoiding the topic so that a potential receiver's face is not threatened.
- **De-escalation:** An effort to decrease relational closeness while avoiding a complete breakup.
- **Defensiveness:** Communication designed to defend oneself against attacks by deflecting blame to someone or something else.
- **Delayed-involvement couples:** Couples who wait until they are a committed couple before they become sexually involved.
- **Demand-withdraw interaction pattern:** See *demand-withdrawal pattern*.
- **Demand-withdrawal pattern:** Also called a *demand-withdraw interaction pattern*. Occurs when one person wants to engage in conflict or demands change whereas the other partner wants to avoid the topic and/or the demanding person and maintain the status quo.
- **Denial, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Pretending not to be jealous or falsely denying feeling jealous.
- **Dependence power:** Reliance on a relationship or partner for power, with people who are dependent on

their relationship for power having lower status than people who are not.

- **Depth:** The extent to which self-disclosure is highly intimate or personal.
- **Derogating competitors:** Communication designed to cast the rival in a bad light, such as making mean comments about a rival.
- **Destiny beliefs:** People's belief that they and their romantic partner are meant for each other and that first impressions about that destiny are fixed and enduring (in contrast to *growth beliefs*).
- **Devaluation:** Feelings of being unappreciated and unimportant, leading to hurt feelings.
- **Dialectical perspective:** A perspective built around the idea that relationships are never completely stable but are constantly changing as people manage seemingly contradictory tensions (such as autonomy vs. connection); integral to dialectics theory.
- **Dialectics theory:** See *dialectical perspective*.
- **Direct emotional expressions:** Directly and unambiguously expressing feelings by using phrases such as "I love you" and "You make me happy" when expressing affection.
- **Direct request:** Simply asking for something.
- **Disclaimers:** Something that individuals say before saying or doing something face threatening such as hedging and credentialing and sin license, cognitive disclaimers, and appeals for suspended judgments.
- **Disclosure-liking hypothesis:** The more we disclose to someone, the more we start to like that person.
- **Discursive tensions:** Messages that have two seemingly contradictory meanings.
- **Dismissive attachment style:** An attachment style based on positive models of self and negative models of others. With this style, autonomy is valued over closeness in relationships.
- **Display rules:** Manipulation and control of emotional expressions such as pretending you understood someone, hiding your anger or sorrow from others, and putting on a happy face when you are sad.
- **Disqualification:** A strategy for managing dialectical tensions that involves being ambiguous so that neither side of the dialectic is engaged. This strategy is a form of neutralization.
- **Distress-maintaining attributions:** Negative behavior is attributed to causes that are internal, stable, and global.
- **Distributive strategies:** People attempt to blame, hurt, insult, or berate their partner in an effort to gain compliance or win an argument.
- **Dominance:** The display or expression of power through behavior.
- **Double-shot hypothesis:** An alternative explanation (compared to the evolutionary hypothesis) for why men get more upset in response to sexual infidelity and women get more upset in response to emotional infidelity. Based on the idea that men assume that women are emotionally connected to men with whom they have sex and women assume that men would like to (or are) having sex with women to whom they are emotionally attached.
- **Drama:** In the context of social media, drama is interpersonal conflict that takes place in front of an active, engaged audience.
- **Dramaturgical perspective:** A perspective suggesting that the world is a stage, people are actors, and we enact performances geared for particular audiences, with performances enacted to advance beneficial images of ourselves.
- **Duration:** How long people engage in self-disclosure or personal conversation with someone.

- **Dyadic effect:** A reciprocal pattern of self-disclosure that occurs when a person reveals information and his or her partner responds by offering information that is at a similar level of intimacy.
- **Dyadic power theory:** The idea that most dominance is displayed by people in equal power positions as they deal with conflict and struggle for control.
- **Dyadic processes phase:** The third phase in the relational dissolution process. These processes focus on how a couple deals with issues that are causing dissatisfaction in their relationship, and can include conflict, avoidance, and/or problem-solving.
- **Efficacy assessment:** Whether people believe they are able to gather the information for which they are searching and then cope with that information.
- **Egalitarian marriage:** A relationship where both spouses are employed, both are actively involved in parenting, and both share in the responsibilities and duties of the household.
- **Emotional attachment:** The feeling in close relationships of being emotionally connected to someone, where the relationship is a primary source of one's emotions.
- **Emotional closeness:** Having a sense of shared feelings, experiences, trust, enjoyment, concern, and caring in a relationship.
- **Emotional flooding:** Occurs when people become surprised, overwhelmed, and disorganized by their partner's expressions of negative emotion during a conflict situation, causing them to feel high levels of arousal that can inhibit effective conflict management.
- **Emotional infidelity:** Emotional involvement with another person to the extent that emotional resources such as romantic love, time, and attention are diverted to that person rather than to one's primary partner.
- **Emotional insensitivity:** When a person fails to tune in to the emotions or feelings of other people.
- **Emotional labor:** A term that describes the effort it takes to show a different emotion than the one being felt. It is generally used to describe that effort in the context of jobs that require manipulation of emotion expression (e.g., servers, first responders).
- **Emotional support:** Helping someone feel better without necessarily trying to solve the problem.
- **Empathic:** The capacity to understand and experience the same emotions as other individuals.
- **Empty love:** Love based on commitment alone rather than on intimacy and passion.
- **Empty threats:** Threatening to do something (like break up with your partner) that you do not really intend to do.
- **Enactment of communication frame:** The component of the communication theory of identity that captures the ways in which we directly or indirectly express our identities to others.
- **Envy:** Wanting something you value that someone else has.
- **Equality:** The belief that resources should be distributed equally among people regardless of their contributions.
- **Equity:** When two people are getting a fair deal in terms of the benefits and costs they are getting as a result of being in a relationship with each other.
- **Equity theory:** A relational perspective for determining whether the distribution of resources is fair to both relational partners.
- **Equivocations:** A deceptive form of communication that involves making an indirect ambiguous

statement, such as saying that your friend's new hairstyle (that you hate) is the "latest fashion" when you are asked if you like it.

- **Eros:** One of Lee's primary love styles. Also called *romantic love* or *passionate love*, it is rooted in feelings of affection, attraction, and sexual desire.
- **Esteem support:** Used to bolster someone's self-worth by making the person feel valued, admired, and capable.
- **Evolutionary hypothesis for infidelity:** Men should get more upset over sexual infidelity than emotional infidelity whereas women should get more upset over emotional infidelity than sexual infidelity, because men and women have different priorities related to mating and parenting (men are concerned with paternal certainty; women are concerned with keeping valued resources).
- **Exaggerations:** A form of deception that involves stretching the truth, often to make oneself look better or to spice up a story.
- **Excitation transfer:** Occurs when emotions caused by one event spill over onto and influence the evaluation of a second event that occurs very soon thereafter.
- **Excuses:** Minimizing responsibility for negative behavior by focusing on the inability to control one's own actions or by shifting the blame to others.
- **Exit, as a coping strategy:** Active, destructive behaviors that are used to decrease closeness or end a relationship.
- **Expectancy violations theory:** A theory that predicts how people will react to unexpected interpersonal behavior based on social norms, expectations, and the reward value of other communicators.
- **Explicit relational talk:** Direct interpersonal communication about interpersonal relationships.
- **Expressions of emotional and physical closeness, as a sexual initiation strategy:** Displaying love, affection, and emotional closeness as a way to initiate sexual activity with someone.
- **Expressive friendships:** Close relationships that involve using emotional nonverbal and verbal communication during conversations, showing nonverbal affection, and having deep conversations (especially applicable to female friendships).
- **Expressive-protective:** The dialectical tension between expressing information versus keeping it private.
- **Extrinsic investments:** Resources or benefits that are developed over time as a result of being in a relationship, such as material possessions, enmeshment within a common social system, and an identity that is attached to being in a relationship.
- **Face-threatening acts (FTAs):** Behaviors that detract from an individual's identity by threatening either that person's positive or negative face desires.
- **Fading away:** A disengagement strategy where both relational partners recognize that the relationship is at a standstill, and they gradually drift apart and lose contact.
- **Failed transition:** Friends-with-benefits relationship where one or both partners enter the arrangement with the intention of eventually becoming a couple; instead they do not move beyond being friends with benefits.
- **Fait accompli approach:** A disengagement strategy that involves breaking up with someone in a direct fashion, often by unequivocally stating that the relationship is over.
- **Fatal attraction:** When the very qualities that draw us to someone eventually contribute to relational

breakup.

- **Fearful attachment style:** An attachment style based on negative models of self and negative models of others. People with this style want to have close relationships, but they are afraid that if they get too close to someone they will get hurt.
- **Fever model of self-disclosure:** When people are distressed about a problem or think about a problem a lot, they are especially likely to reveal their thoughts and feelings or to tell a secret.
- **Flaming:** Hostile expression of emotions online through means such as swearing, insulting, and name-calling.
- **Forgiveness:** A relational process that has four characteristics: (1) acknowledgment of harmful conduct, (2) an extension of undeserved mercy, (3) an emotional transformation, and (4) relationship renegotiation.
- **Four horsemen of the apocalypse:** A destructive conflict pattern that includes the following four behaviors: (1) complaints/criticisms, (2) contempt/disgust, (3) defensiveness, and (4) stonewalling.
- **Frequency:** As a dimension of self-disclosure, this refers to how often people self-disclose.
- **Friends-with-benefits relationship:** A sexual but nonromantic relationship between friends or acquaintances.
- **Friends with benefits:** Friends or acquaintances who decide to have a sexual relationship but not be a romantic couple.
- **Friendship love:** Love based on intimacy and commitment that has little passion.
- **Fundamental relational themes:** Messages that reflect the nature of a relationship, such as dominance/submission, intimacy, degree of similarity, task/social orientation, formality/informality, social composure, and emotional activation.
- **Futility of discussion:** A motive for topic avoidance that involves believing it is pointless to talk about something.
- **General equity:** An overall assessment that two people's benefits and contributions are balanced.
- **Generation Z:** Individuals born between 1996 and 2010 who grew up immersed in communication technologies.
- **Ghosting:** A term that refers to stopping all contact (e.g., texting, snapping, seeing each other) as a way to break up or signal that one is no longer interested in someone.
- **Goal-linking:** Being with a particular person is linked to more general life goals, such as happiness; makes a relationship more desirable.
- **Going off-record strategy:** A strategy that involves giving primary attention to face and little attention to task.
- **Gradual separators, as a type of on-again off-again relationship:** Couples that grow farther apart from one another during their "off" phases so that the relationship fades out over time as the "on" periods get shorter.
- **Gradual-involvement couples:** Couples who let sexual activity increase progressively as the relationship develops and they become more psychologically intimate.
- **Grave-dressing processes phase:** The fourth stage of the relational dissolution process. Involves the public presentation of the break-up, often includes communication that helps people save face.

- **Growth beliefs:** Beliefs that impressions of others and attractions to others evolve over time, and that people and relationships grow when faced with challenges (in contrast to *destiny beliefs*).
- **Gunnysacking:** Occurs when people store up old grievances and then dump them on their partner during a conflict.
- **Habitual, as a type of on-again off-again relationship:** Couples who break up and get back together without thinking much about what happened during transitions. Instead, they fall into old habits because the relationship is comfortable, easy, and convenient.
- **Halo effect:** The process whereby people think another person has favorable qualities based on another irrelevant quality (e.g., people who are attractive are smart).
- **Haptics:** The study of the use of touch, ranging from affectionate to violent touch.
- **High-outcome value:** A judgment that someone is highly rewarding and a relationship with that person would be a positive experience.
- **Hinting:** Implying a request without ever coming out and stating it. Also called *indirect requests* or *suggesting*.
- **Hinting and indirect strategies, as a sexual initiation strategy:** Indirect communication such as compliments, sexual innuendo, hints, and nonverbal communication that shows interest in engaging in sexual activity.
- **Hook-ups:** Sexual activity, ranging from making out to having sex, without commitment.
- **Hurtful messages:** Words that elicit psychological pain.
- **Hyperaccessibility:** When particular memories are especially accessible to us, or when they are at the tip of our thoughts. This typically occurs in the context of secrets when, in certain contexts, the information in those secrets becomes hyperaccessible.
- **Hyperintimacy:** Sending repeated and unwanted messages of interest and affection.
- **Idealization:** The process where people think about and describe their relationship and their partner in glowing, overly positive terms that sometimes reflect unrealistic expectations.
- **Idealization effect:** According to this hypothesis, people who communicate exclusively online for an extended period of time tend to idealize one another and have high expectations about what their relationship would be like if they were to interact in person, which can lead to disappointment when they communicate face to face and are able to make more-realistic assessments.
- **Ideal-real:** The dialectical tension between what the friendship or relationship “ought to be” and what it “really is.”
- **Identity:** The person we think we are and the self we communicate to others.
- **Identity management:** The process people use to project and maintain a positive image to others.
- **Ideologies:** Collections of beliefs, values, and expectations about life, including love.
- **Idiomatic behaviors:** Behaviors that have a specific meaning only to people within a particular relationship.
- **Illicit ingratiation:** When a person acts nice merely to gain compliance.
- **Immediacy behaviors:** Actions that signal warmth, communicate availability, decrease psychological or physical distance, and promote involvement between people.
- **Implicit egotism:** States that we are attracted to others based on similarity on arbitrary things, such as

names and birthdates.

- **Inclusion-seclusion:** A dialectical tension that is expressed when dyads communicate in ways that stress the importance of spending time with other people, but also spending time alone with each other.
- **Independent-dependent:** A dialectical tension between wanting the freedom to pursue individual activities and depending on someone for help and support.
- **Indirect fighting:** An indirect and uncooperative conflict style that involves using passive-aggressive behaviors such as rolling one's eyes or pulling away from one's partner.
- **Indirect requests:** An implied influence attempt that involves suggesting or hinting without ever making a direct request.
- **Individual secrets:** Confidences where information is held by a single individual and kept secret from others.
- **Inductive philosophy:** A parenting philosophy that involves providing children with reasons for disciplinary actions.
- **Inequity:** An imbalanced relationship in terms of the benefits each person is getting and costs each person is paying, such that one person is getting a better deal than the other (i.e., more benefits, lower costs, or both).
- **Infatuation:** A form of incomplete love based on passion only.
- **Influence:** The ability to persuade others to think and act in certain ways.
- **Influence strategies:** Specific behaviors that people use to try to get others to think and/or act in certain ways.
- **Informational familiarity:** Knowing certain information about your relational partner, such as your partner's age or educational background, preventing your partner from being able to lie to you about those things.
- **Informational support:** Giving specific advice, including facts and information that might help someone solve a problem.
- **Ingratiation:** Using excessive kindness or doing favors for someone to gain popularity or get one's way.
- **Instrumental goals:** Goals related to tasks, such as making money, getting good grades, buying a car, getting a ride to school, and completing a homework assignment.
- **Integrative communication:** A style of communication that is direct and nonaggressive and typically involves problem solving.
- **Intensification effect:** The idea that personal self-disclosure produces more-powerful feelings of closeness and liking in computer-mediated contexts than in face-to-face interaction.
- **Intentional transition in, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** Relationship where partners who start out in a friends-with-benefits relationship intend to become a couple and then actually do.
- **Interaction appearance theory:** The perspective that explains why people perceive others as more physically attractive if they have warm, positive interactions with them.
- **Interactors:** When used to describe a type of user of a social networking site, this term refers to people who use sites such as Twitter and Facebook primarily to interact and connect with friends and acquaintances on a reciprocal basis and to establish close relationships.
- **Intergenerational transmission of divorce:** The idea that divorce increases the likelihood that children

in that same family will ultimately end up divorced. Children of divorced parents are more likely to get divorced than are children of nondivorced parents.

- **Internal working models:** Cognitive representations of oneself and potential partners that reflect an individual's past experiences in close relationships and that help that individual understand the world.
- **Interpersonal communication:** The exchange of nonverbal and/or verbal messages between two people, regardless of the relationship they share (a broader term than *relational communication*).
- **Interpersonal influence:** The process of one person influencing another person's thoughts and/or behaviors, including getting someone to change a position and getting someone to do something.
- **Interpersonal relationship:** A connection between two people who share repeated interactions over time, can influence one another, and who have unique interaction patterns.
- **Interpersonal valence:** The degree to which someone is considered attractive and rewarding.
- **Interpersonally sensitive:** A person who is empathic and understanding, and who connects with another person's perspective.
- **Intimacy:** The part of relationships based on feelings of emotional connection and closeness and has been called the warm part of love.
- **Intimate terrorism:** A strategic, enduring pattern that involves using violence to control a partner.
- **Intrafamily secrets:** Confidences where some family members have information they keep from other family members.
- **Intrapsychic processes phase:** The first phase of the dissolution model. Involves thinking about the positive and negative aspects of a relationship to evaluate whether you want to stay in it or possibly break up.
- **Intrinsic investments:** Resources that are put directly into the relationship, including time, effort, affection, and disclosure.
- **Investment model of relationship-maintaining behavior:** The perspective that commitment leads people to use behaviors that help them maintain their relationships even when problems or dissatisfaction occur. This model is an extension of the original investment model, which focuses on how satisfaction, investments, and alternatives predict commitment.
- **Investments:** Resources tied to a relationship that would decline in value or be lost if the relationship were to end.
- **Invisible support phenomenon:** The idea that attempts at support that go unnoticed by recipients are the most effective in reducing distress and promoting good health.
- **Invitations and sexual arousal stage:** The fourth stage in the courtship process. In this stage partners focus on showing sexual attraction to one another, often by subtle touch and sexual contact.
- **Invulnerable responses:** Responses that involve acting unaffected by something, such as acting like a hurtful remark did not bother you.
- **Irreplaceability:** The perception that a person has a special place in your thoughts and emotions, as well as in your social network, such that no one else can take that person's place. Irreplaceability helps distinguish close relationships from other types of relationships.
- **Isolated common couple violence:** Inappropriate physical aggression that occurs on rare occasions in a relationship when conflicts become especially heated.

- **Jealousy:** Thoughts and feelings about losing something you value, such as a good relationship, due to interference from a rival.
- **Jealousy induction:** Intentionally trying to make your partner jealous.
- **Judgment-acceptance:** The dialectical tension between accepting a friend for who he or she is versus feeling free to offer criticism and advice.
- **Just sex, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** Sexual partners whose interaction revolves almost exclusively around planning and having sex without any real emotional connection.
- **Justifications:** When used as a remedial strategy, this involves trying to minimize the negative implications of your actions by denying your behavior was wrong or saying that what you did isn't that bad.
- **Kinesics:** Body movement including facial expressions and eye behavior, such as posture, gestures, walking style, smiling, and pupil dilation, among other related cues.
- **Kitchen sinking:** When people rehash groups of old arguments when they get into a new argument so that there are too many issues to deal with at once.
- **Language of acts of service:** This love language involves helping with necessary tasks by doing things such as helping with housework and running errands for one's partner.
- **Language of affirmation and support:** This love language involves being encouraging, supportive, and complimentary.
- **Language of gifts and tokens of affection:** This love language involves giving gifts and doing special things for one's partner.
- **Language of physical touch:** This love language involves communicating love mainly through physical contact.
- **Language of time together:** This love language involves spending time together talking and participating in shared activities.
- **Latent intimacy:** Internal feelings of closeness and interpersonal warmth that are not directly observable by others.
- **Lies:** Made-up information or information that is the opposite of (or at least very different from) the truth. Lies are also called *falsifications* or *fabrications*.
- **Liking:** A feeling or connection characterized by affection and respect. According to the triangular theory of love, liking occurs when people experience high levels of intimacy and low levels of commitment and passion.
- **Liking-disclosure hypothesis:** According to this hypothesis, we are more likely to disclose information to people we like.
- **Logic and reasoning, as a sexual initiation strategy:** Persuading someone that it is advantageous and/or safe to become sexually involved.
- **Loss-gain effect:** Attraction lessens when a person's behavior moves from positive to negative. In fact, people are less attracted to those who initially enact positive behavior and then enact negative behavior than they are to those who consistently enact negative behavior.
- **Love languages:** Five languages that represent preferred ways of communicating and receiving love.
- **Love ways:** The seven categories of physiological and behavioral responses to love, created by Marston

and colleagues, which represents the experiences of over 90% of lovers.

- **Low-outcome value:** A judgment that someone is more costly than rewarding and a relationship with that person would be a negative experience.
- **Low-involvement couples:** Couples who wait until they are engaged or married before having sex.
- **Loyalty, as a coping strategy:** Passive, constructive behaviors that involve waiting for positive change by hoping that things will improve, standing by the partner during difficult times, and supporting the partner in the face of criticism.
- **Ludus:** One of Lee's primary love styles, also called *game-playing love*. Ludus is based on having low levels of commitment and seeing relationships as fun, playful, and casual.
- **Mania:** One of Lee's secondary love styles, based on a combination of eros and ludus. Mania involves having a possessive style of loving.
- **Manifest intimacy:** External manifestations of closeness and affection that involve communication, such as hugging or kissing.
- **Manipulation:** A set of strategies used to get one's way by doing things such as making the partner feel guilty, ashamed, or jealous.
- **Matching hypothesis:** Our tendency to be attracted to people who are similar to us in terms of level of attractiveness.
- **Mental maps:** Thinking about how your partner is feeling and trying to understand his or her perspective.
- **Metatalk:** Talking about the way you communicate.
- **Millennials:** The generation that was born between 1980 and around 1995. Millennials grew up at a time when the use of computer-mediated communication was expanding rapidly.
- **Mind reading:** Occurs when people assume (often mistakenly) that they know their partner's feelings, motives, and behaviors.
- **Miscommunication:** Someone sending an intentional message that is misinterpreted by the receiver.
- **Misinterpretation:** Someone unintentionally sending a message that is misinterpreted by the receiver.
- **Mismatched, as a type of on-again off-again relationship:** These relationships are characterized by unequal involvement in terms of how motivated and committed partners are at different times during the course of the relationship.
- **Modality:** The channel of communication.
- **Model of accommodation:** A model that describes how people respond to problems or dissatisfying events in their relationships using neglect, exit, voice, or loyalty.
- **Model of relational turbulence:** An approach that tries to explain the way partners communicate during periods of turbulent changes in a relationship such as the transition from casual dating to commitment or a partner's diagnosis of a chronic illness.
- **Moderation:** A strategy for managing dialectical tensions that involves striving to reach a midpoint such that couples engage both sides of the dialectic but only to a certain extent. Moderation is a form of neutralization.
- **Moral violations:** Behavior that deviates from what is considered right or moral.
- **Mutual influence:** Two people affect one another in meaningful ways. Mutual influence increases as

relationships move beyond role relationships to become interpersonal or close.

- **Narcissism:** A personality trait that involves a pervasive pattern of grandiosity, self-focus, and self-importance.
- **Need fulfillment:** When a partner fulfills critical interpersonal needs, such as the need to belong to a social group, to feel loved and appreciated, or to care for and nurture someone.
- **Negative affect strategy:** Also called *aversive stimulation*, involves whining, pouting, sulking, complaining, crying, or acting angry to get one's way.
- **Negative altercasting:** Negative compliance-gaining strategies where one person's positive motivations are questioned.
- **Negative communication, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Aggressive and passive-aggressive communication that reflects negativity, such as arguing, being sarcastic, acting rude, ignoring the partner, giving cold or dirty looks, and withdrawing affection.
- **Negative face:** The part of us that wants to be free from imposition and restraint and to have control over our own resources.
- **Negative identity management:** A sender imposes her or his solution on a receiver at the expense of the receiver's feelings.
- **Negative moral appeals:** The suggestion that only bad or immoral people would fail to comply.
- **Negative politeness strategy:** A set of tactics intended to save the receiver's negative face while still accomplishing the task.
- **Negative psychic change:** A turning point that occurs when attitudes and perceptions become more negative.
- **Neglect, as a coping strategy:** Passive, destructive behaviors that involve standing by and letting conditions in the relationship get worse.
- **Network opportunism, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** Partners within the same social network who are not particularly close but who serve as a sexual backup if neither of them is with someone else.
- **Network support:** Directing someone to a person or group who can help them, often because they have had similar experiences.
- **Neutral symmetry:** When both partners exchange one-across messages in conversation.
- **Neutralization:** A way of managing dialectic tension that involves avoiding full engagement of either side of the dialectical tension through moderation (striving to reach a midpoint) or disqualification (being ambiguous so that neither side of the dialectic is engaged).
- **Nondirected disclosure:** Disclosure that is sent to large groups of people rather than to individuals and is therefore considered less personal.
- **Objective power:** The authority associated with tangible factors such as position, strength, weaponry, and wealth.
- **Obsessive relational intrusion (ORI):** Unwanted behaviors that invade someone's privacy and that are used for the purpose of trying to get close to someone.
- **Oculesics:** Eye behavior. This behavior helps establish emotional closeness.
- **On-again off-again relationship:** Also called *cycling relationships*, these relationships are defined by

breaking up and then getting back together at least once.

- **One-across messages:** Neutral messages that are neither dominant nor submissive.
- **One-down messages:** Deferent, submissive, or accepting messages.
- **One-up messages:** Dominant or controlling messages.
- **Online infidelity:** Romantic or sexual contact facilitated by Internet use that is considered to violate relationship rules regarding faithfulness.
- **Openness-closedness:** The dialectical tension that focuses on how people struggle between their need to be open with relational partners while also wanting to keep some information to themselves.
- **Outcome:** A person's calculation of the rewards in a current relationship minus the costs for being in that same relationship.
- **Outcome expectancy:** Predictions about the outcome of an information search as positive or negative.
- **Outcome values:** Predictions about how rewarding or unrewarding future interactions with a particular person would be.
- **Overbenefited:** The state of getting a better deal than your partner in terms of receiving more benefits, making fewer contributions, or both, so that the ratio of benefits to contributions favors you more than your partner.
- **Panache:** An elusive quality that some people have that commands attention, draws others in, and makes them memorable.
- **Paradox of affection:** Although affection is often intended and usually perceived by others to be a positive communicative move, it can backfire and produce negative outcomes such as distress and relationship dissolution.
- **Paralinguistics:** The study of the voice, including voice qualities like pitch, volume, rate, and accent.
- **Partner uncertainty:** Occurs when a person is uncertain about a partner's feelings and intentions, including whether the partner reciprocates the individual's feelings.
- **Partner unresponsiveness:** When a person perceives that a partner will be unhelpful or insensitive to the individual's needs.
- **Passion:** Interpersonal excitation that is often, but not always, sexual. The hot component in Sternberg's triangular theory of love, involving motivation and arousal.
- **Passionate love:** Also called *eros* or *romantic love*, it is based on intimacy, passion, and low commitment.
- **Passive aggression:** Indirect ways of communicating hostility, such as giving a partner the silent treatment, withholding affection, or rolling one's eyes.
- **Peer marriage:** Both spouses are employed, both are actively involved in parenting, and both share in the responsibilities and duties of the household.
- **Permissive parents:** Undemanding, nondirective, and overly responsive parents.
- **Personal frame:** The component of communication theory of identity that captures the personal characteristics we perceive in ourselves (e.g., smart, athletic, nice).
- **Personalistic disclosure:** Disclosure that people think is directed at them because they are trustworthy and have a close relationship with the sender.
- **Person-centered messages:** Communication that acknowledges, elaborates on, and validates the feelings and concerns of a distressed person.

- **Physical abuse:** Violent behaviors such as grabbing, kicking, biting, slapping, and punching.
- **Physical attraction:** Being drawn to a person's looks, including someone's body, eyes, hair, attire, or other aspects of a person's appearance.
- **Physical closeness:** The amount of spatial proximity and physical contact people have.
- **Physical distance:** The amount physical space between people.
- **Physical flirting style:** Focuses on communicating sexual and romantic interest through behavior such as touch and sexual innuendo.
- **Physiological self-soothing:** The antidote to stonewalling, this involves taking a break from the conflict to calm down and regain one's thoughts.
- **Pillow talk:** Tranquil, intimate conversation that takes place after sexual intercourse or sexual climax.
- **Pinocchio relationships:** Partners first meet online but then start meeting in person (i.e., they become "real").
- **Playful flirting style:** Flirting that is fun rather than serious; not usually intended to start a relationship with someone.
- **Poise:** Appearing smooth and calm during stressful situations.
- **Polite flirting style:** Flirting where touch and other types of behavior that could be interpreted as inappropriate are avoided.
- **Politeness theory:** Brown and Levinson's extension of Goffman's work, which focuses on the specific ways that people manage and save face using communication.
- **Positioning stage:** The third stage in the courtship process. It involves signaling availability for interaction while indicating to others that two people are, at least temporarily, a couple that should be left alone by using behaviors such as close distancing, touch, and face-to-face body orientation.
- **Positive altercasting:** Compliance-gaining strategies that suggest a good person would behave in a particular way.
- **Positive face:** The favorable image that people hope to portray to others and to have validated by others. The best face we put forward so that others will like us.
- **Positive involvement behaviors:** Also called *immediacy behaviors*, these behaviors show both positive affect and high levels of involvement in an interaction.
- **Positive moral appeals:** Telling someone that a good or moral person would comply with a certain request.
- **Positive politeness strategy:** A strategy addressing the receiver's positive face while still accomplishing the task.
- **Positive psychic change:** A turning point that occurs when attitudes and perceptions become more positive.
- **Positive reciprocity:** A pattern where both partners engage in cooperative or immediate behavior.
- **Positive-tone strategy:** When used to break up, this strategy is designed to lessen the dumped person's hurt feelings and make her or him feel better about the breakup.
- **Power:** An individual's perceived ability to control or influence as well as to resist the influence attempts of others.
- **Power assertion, as a parenting style:** Occurs when parents demand compliance from their children

without thinking they have to explain why.

- **Powerful speech:** Speakers using this style “own” what they are saying, dominate conversations, redirect the conversation away from topics others are discussing, and interrupt others.
- **Powerless speech:** A weak form of speech in which people use tag questions and hedges to qualify what they are saying.
- **Pragma:** One of Lee’s secondary love styles, based on a combination of storge and ludus, pragma involves having a practical style of love that focuses on finding a person who has specific desired characteristics.
- **Predictability-novelty:** The dialectical tension that focuses on how people struggle between their needs for stability and change in their relationships.
- **Predicted outcome value theory:** A theory based on the idea that people only seek to reduce uncertainty about someone if they see that person as rewarding.
- **Predictive expectancies:** What type of behavior people think *will* occur in a situation based on personal knowledge about someone (vs. prescriptive expectancies).
- **Pregiving:** When used as a persuasive strategy, this involves someone doing a favor for another person prior to asking for a return favor.
- **Preoccupied attachment style:** An attachment style based on negative models of self and positive models of others. People with this style desire excessive closeness and need relationships to validate their self-worth.
- **Prerogative principle:** Powerful people can violate norms, break relational rules, and manage interactions without as much penalty as powerless people.
- **Prescriptive expectancies:** What type of behavior people think *should* occur in a situation based on social and cultural norms (vs. predictive expectancies).
- **Pressure and manipulation, as a sexual initiation strategy:** Using coercive tactics such as repeated requests for sex, threats to break off or de-escalate the relationship, the use of drugs or alcohol to reduce resistance to sex, and/or deception to initiate sexual activity with someone.
- **Preventive facework:** Efforts to avoid or minimize potential face threat or to thwart future damage by framing the message in friendlier, softer terms.
- **Primary appraisals:** Initial evaluations about whether feelings are good or bad, warranted or not warranted, and so on. When applied to jealousy, primary appraisals evaluate the existence and quality of a rival relationship, including how much of a threat the third party is.
- **Principle of elevation:** This principle states that height or vertical position is associated with power.
- **Principle of least interest:** The idea that when a difference exists in the intensity of positive feelings between partners, the partner who feels more positive feelings is at a power disadvantage.
- **Principle of negative reciprocity:** This principle states that aggression or negative expressions beget more of the same.
- **Privacy control:** The idea that people want control over their personal information, including who knows personal information, and both whether and how those people share the information with others.
- **Privacy maintenance:** People may avoid specific topics as a way to maintain privacy.
- **Privacy ownership:** This states that people own their personal information and if they share that

information with others, those people have a responsibility to keep it private unless granted permission to do otherwise.

- **Privacy turbulence:** Occurs when new events force renewed boundary management; in other words, events force people to think about how their private information is being managed and whether they need to change who has access to it.
- **Procreational orientation:** The belief that producing offspring is the primary purpose of sexual intercourse.
- **Prosocial communication:** Positive behaviors that promote relational closeness, trust, and liking.
- **Proxemics:** The way people use space, including conversational distances and territory.
- **Pseudo de-escalation:** A deceptive, unethical breakup strategy where a person says that she or he wants to decrease closeness but actually wants to end the relationship altogether.
- **Psychological abuse:** Hurtful communication such as insults, name-calling, and personal criticisms.
- **Psychological reactance:** A theory that maintains that influence attempts may backfire or boomerang, thereby causing resistance to the request.
- **Public-private:** The dialectical tension that focuses on how people struggle between acting certain ways in the presence of others and other ways when alone.
- **Punctuation:** When both partners think that their negative communication is caused by the other person's behavior (e.g., I think I act demanding because you withdraw, and you think that you withdraw because I act demanding).
- **Punishment:** Trying to balance the relationship by engaging in negative behavior (such as withdrawing affection) that might lead the partner to act to restore closeness.
- **Quality of alternatives:** How one's relationship compares to the kinds of outcomes a person thinks he or she could have by exploring other options (such as starting a new relationship or being alone).
- **Quasi-courtship:** Engaging in courtship-like behaviors (such as flirting with each other) without such behavior leading to sexual involvement.
- **Rapid-involvement couples:** Couples who have high levels of physical arousal and have sex on the first date or shortly thereafter.
- **Rebound effect:** When discussed as part of thought suppression, this is the idea that people can temporarily suppress thoughts about a negative event if they are away from the event (or the person who caused it), but those thoughts will come flooding back as soon as something triggers their memory.
- **Recreational orientation:** As a sexual attitude, the belief that sexual intercourse is primarily a source of fun, escape, excitement, or pleasure.
- **Reflection enhancing:** Behaviors that encourage children to think about their misconduct, including how their actions affect themselves and others.
- **Reframing:** A sophisticated way of managing dialectical tension that involves talking about tensions so that they seem complementary rather than contradictory.
- **Reinforcement affect model:** Certain types of environments make people feel good; people unconsciously associate those good feelings with the people with whom they are interacting in the environment.
- **Reinforcement effect:** When discussed in attachment theory, this means that people communicate in

cycles that reinforce their positive or negative models of self and others, leading one's attachment style to stay fairly consistent over time.

- **Reinforcement model:** A perspective used to explain that people are attracted to similar others in part because similarity reinforces and validates our beliefs and values.
- **Relational closeness:** Being interdependent in terms of exchanging resources and intimacy; meeting each other's needs; and influencing one another's thoughts, behaviors, and emotions.
- **Relational communication:** A subset of interpersonal communication that focuses on the expression and interpretation of messages within close relationships. Relational communication includes the gamut of interactions from vital relational messages to mundane everyday interactions.
- **Relational dialectics theory:** A perspective that indicates people have opposing interpersonal needs that exist in dynamic tension, that these tensions are evident in discourse, and that the success of relationships depends on how we manage these tensions.
- **Relational goal pursuit theory:** A theory built on the idea that people expend energy to develop or reinitiate relationships to the extent that they perceive a relationship is desirable and attainable.
- **Relational goals:** Relational objectives or states that we pursue and that often motivate our communication choices.
- **Relational level:** The relational level of a message provides a context for interpreting communication within the broader context of a relationship. Nonverbal cues are a primary part of the relational level of a message.
- **Relational maintenance:** Efforts to keep a relationship at a specified state or at a desired level of closeness.
- **Relational orientation:** As a sexual attitude, the belief that sexual intercourse is a way of expressing love and affection and developing greater relational intimacy.
- **Relational ruses:** A breakup strategy that involves using indirect manipulative strategies to end a relationship, such as having a third party leak the news of the impending breakup.
- **Relational satisfaction:** Pleasure or enjoyment that people derive from their relationships. In interdependence theory, relational satisfaction is defined as having a relationship where rewards exceed costs at a level that meets or exceeds expectations.
- **Relational transgressions:** Actions that violate implicit or explicit relational rules (e.g., infidelity, deception).
- **Relational Turbulence Theory:** A theory that explains how cognition, emotion, and communication impact one another to shape experiences of relationship as either chaotic or smooth.
- **Relationship de-escalation:** The process of decreasing closeness in a relationship.
- **Relationship disillusionment:** People's positive perceptions about their partners and their relationships start to fade.
- **Relationship frame:** The component of the communication theory of identity that captures the aspects of our identity that are tied to our relationships with other people.
- **Relationship invocation:** Expressing attitudes or beliefs about the relationship or using the qualities of the relationship as a backdrop for interpreting a relational transgression.
- **Relationship protection:** As a motivation for topic avoidance, when people avoid talking about things

because they think talking about them will harm their relationship.

- **Relationship uncertainty:** A lack of confidence in the ability to predict the current or future state of the relationship.
- **Relationship-enhancing attributions:** Negative behavior is attributed to causes that are external, unstable, and specific.
- **Relationships:** Ongoing interactions between people that result in interpersonal, affective, and behavioral connections.
- **Relative power:** One person's level of power in comparison to someone else's level of power.
- **Remedial strategies:** Attempts to correct problems, restore one's positive face, and/or repair a relationship.
- **Repeated common couple violence:** Physical aggression that occurs intermittently in a relationship when conflicts get especially heated.
- **Resolution stage:** The fifth and final stage in the courtship process. This stage is defined by having sex, and separates courtship (which includes sex) from quasi-courtship (which does not).
- **Responsiveness:** A communication style that shows care, concern, and liking.
- **Resurrection processes phase:** The fifth and final stage of the relational dissolution process, wherein people move on by visualizing their future without their old relationship and learning from their past experiences.
- **Retaliatory responses:** Trying to get back at someone or get revenge on someone.
- **Revelation-concealment:** A dialectical tension that involves the push and pull between wanting to reveal aspects of your relationship to others, but also wanting to keep parts of your relationship private.
- **Rewards:** Exchanged resources that are pleasurable and gratifying.
- **Rival contacts:** Direct communication with a potential rival by a jealous person.
- **Role relationship:** Two people who share some degree of behavioral interdependence, although people in such relationships are usually interchangeable and are not psychologically or behaviorally unique.
- **Romantic intent:** Desire to move the friendship toward a romantic relationship.
- **Romantic jealousy:** When people believe that a third party threatens the existence or quality of their primary love relationship.
- **Romantic love:** Also called *eros* or *passionate love*. It is based on intimacy and passion, and low commitment.
- **Romantic relationship transitions:** The periods of time when a relationship changes from being either platonic or nonexistent to being romantic, or vice versa.
- **"Romeo and Juliet" effect:** The notion that parental interference or disapproval of their children's romantic relationship can strengthen the attraction between those two people.
- **Routine maintenance behavior:** Everyday behaviors that help people preserve their bonds with one another.
- **Rumination:** Repeated mulling over certain information or behavior.
- **Sacrifice or support:** Being there to help and comfort someone in crises, such as dealing with the death of a loved one or helping someone regain confidence after an embarrassing failure.
- **Scarcity hypothesis:** The notion that hard-to-get resources are especially desirable. People have the most

power when the resources they possess are hard to come by or in high demand.

- **Scripts:** Social information about how one should act in a particular situation.
- **Secondary appraisals:** Evaluations about the causes and consequences of one's feelings. When applied to jealousy, secondary appraisals include comparing oneself to the rival, thinking about what would happen if the relationship were to end, and so on.
- **Secure attachment style:** A social interaction style based on positive models of self and positive models of others. People with this style are comfortable getting close to and depending on others, seldom worry about being abandoned, and strive for a balance of autonomy and closeness in relationships.
- **Secure base:** In attachment theory, this is the idea that children feel secure about exploring their environment when a preferred caregiver is present to go back to if they need help or are uncomfortable. (The preferred caregiver is the secure base.)
- **Selection:** A way of managing dialectic tension that involves talking about the tension in a way that values one side of the dialectic over the other (e.g., openness over closedness).
- **Selection effect:** People who choose to cohabit rather than marry have certain preexisting personal characteristics and attitudes that make it less likely that their relationships will last.
- **Self-assurance:** Confidence that emanates from a person's focus, drive, and leadership qualities.
- **Self-disclosure:** Revealing personal information about oneself to others.
- **Self-expansion theory:** A theory that maintains that people have relationships to grow and extend their own selves.
- **Self-focused motives:** Reasons to act in particular ways focused on personal benefits or consequences.
- **Self-fulfilling prophecy:** A prophecy that occurs when an expectation exists that an event will happen and a person behaves in a way (often unconsciously) that actually makes it more likely that the anticipated event will occur.
- **Self-presentation:** The things we do to portray a particular image of self.
- **Self-presentational goals:** Motivations that relate to the image we want to convey.
- **Self-uncertainty:** When people question their own feelings about how involved they want to be with another person.
- **Separation:** A way of managing dialectical tensions that involves favoring each side of the dialectic at different times using either cyclic alternation (moving from one side of the dialectic to the other in a cyclical fashion) or topical segmentation (emphasizing different sides of the dialectic depending on the topic or context).
- **Separation and individuation:** Teenagers distance themselves, to some degree, from their parents and develop an individual identity apart from their family structure.
- **Serial monogamy:** Couples are sexually active only with each other (monogamy) and do not engage in other sexual relationships until the current relationship ends. They may, however, move through a series of such relationships.
- **Sexual attraction:** The desire to engage in sexual activity with someone, typically accompanied by feelings of sexual arousal in the presence of the person.
- **Sexual infidelity:** Engaging in sexual activity with someone other than one's long-term partner.
- **Sexual scripts:** Social information about how to initiate, accept, or refuse sexual advances.

- **Shift in motivation:** In relational pursuit theory, the shift that occurs when someone's motives change from wanting a relationship with someone who does not want them, to getting revenge on that person.
- **Signs of possession, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Public displays designed to show people that one's partner is taken, such as holding the partner's hand.
- **Silence, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Decreasing communication, often by getting quiet and not talking as much as usual, when feeling jealous.
- **Simple request:** Directly asking for something.
- **Sincere flirting style:** The flirting style aimed at creating an emotional bond and making a real connection with someone.
- **Social attraction:** The feeling that we would like to spend time with someone and that the person would fit well into our circle of friends.
- **Social identity theory:** A perspective focusing on the way in which people's identification with groups shapes their behavior, toward both members of that group and members of other groups.
- **Social influence:** Changing someone's thoughts, emotions, or behaviors.
- **Social meaning model of nonverbal communication:** Some nonverbal behaviors have strong consensual meanings across different contexts.
- **Social penetration theory:** A theory that describes how self-disclosure changes as people develop their relationships. It is sometimes referred to as the *onion theory*.
- **Social processes phase:** The fourth phase in the relational dissolution process. In this phase people talk to people in their social network about problems in their relationship, including a possible breakup.
- **Social support withdrawal:** Not using supportive behaviors such as listening, comforting, or just being there for someone.
- **Social violations:** People fail to act in relationally appropriate ways and instead engage in rude, cold, critical, or condescending behavior.
- **Socialization effect:** When related to divorce, this effect suggests that children who have parents who frequently engage in aggressive conflict do worse in school and have trouble interacting with their peers in part because children adopt conflict styles similar to their parents' conflict styles.
- **Specific equity:** The balance between people's benefits and contributions in a specific area, such as physical attractiveness, financial resources, social status, ability to influence each other, and supportiveness.
- **Spies:** When applied to people who use social networking sites, these people primarily use sites like Facebook and Twitter to learn things about others.
- **Spillover effect:** The notion that the emotional state of one member of a dyad or group influences (or spills over into) the emotional states, cognitive states, and behaviors of other members of the dyad/group.
- **Split loyalty pattern:** Those who keep secrets are often put in a bind of having to choose between being loyal to other secret holders or being loyal to friends or family members who may be hurt by not knowing the secret.
- **Stalking:** Repeated and unwanted contact that is threatening and/or fear-provoking.
- **Standards for openness hypothesis:** The idea that people differ in their expectations for how open their

partner should be. That difference often falls along sex categories (i.e., women have higher expectations for openness than men).

- **Stonewalling:** When a person builds a metaphorical wall around herself or himself, shuts down, and withdraws from interaction with another person.
- **Storge:** One of Lee's primary love styles, also called *friendship of companionate love*, it is based on high levels of intimacy and commitment but comparatively low levels of passion.
- **Strategic maintenance behaviors:** Behaviors intentionally designed to maintain a relationship.
- **Submissive symmetry:** During dyadic communication, when both people repeatedly use one-down moves in conversation.
- **Successful communication:** A sender's message is interpreted correctly by a receiver. (This is the most effective form of communication.)
- **Suggesting:** Implying something without ever coming out and stating it. It is also called *indirect requests* or *hinting*.
- **Support behaviors:** Giving someone emotional or instrumental support.
- **Surveillance:** Information-seeking behaviors designed to find out about a potential rival relationship, including behaviors such as stalking social media or checking up on the partner.
- **Symmetrical behavior:** During dyadic interaction, when both people in a relationship use the same verbal or nonverbal behavior.
- **Tangible aid:** People provide physical assistance, goods, or services, such as babysitting someone's children or helping someone complete a task.
- **Task attraction:** A person's attraction to another person is based on the perception that it would be good to work with that person.
- **Theory of motivated information management (TMIM):** A theory that examines how people respond to uncertainty. Tries to understand when people will seek information and when they will avoid seeking information based on the difference between desired and actual levels of uncertainty, expected outcomes, the ability to gather information, and the ability to cope with the information that might be discovered.
- **Theory of self:** The idea that our identities help us understand ourselves in relation to the world in which we live, and that the self is made up of self-esteem and identity.
- **Threats:** Tactics such as threatening to walk out on the partner, failing to cooperate with the partner until the partner gives in, or threatening to withhold resources such as money and information.
- **Topic avoidance:** Intentionally averting the discussion of a particular topic.
- **Topical segmentation:** A way of managing dialectical tensions that emphasizes different sides of the dialectic depending on the topic or context.
- **Traditional flirting style:** Flirting based on the traditional belief that men chase whereas women respond to men's advances, and that men communicate their interest more verbally whereas women communicate their interest more nonverbally.
- **Traditional marriages:** Men and women have clearly specialized roles based on gender stereotypes.
- **Transact:** A pair of utterances.
- **Transgression-maximizing messages:** Messages that highlight the negative aspects of the transgression as well as the partner's role in causing that negativity. An example would be blaming the partner or

talking about how hurt one is.

- **Transgression-minimizing messages:** Messages that focus on downplaying the severity of the transgression by using strategies such as saying that the partner's behavior was unintentional, explaining or justifying the partner's behavior, or saying that it is not a big deal.
- **Transition:** When a one-up or one-down message is paired with a one-across message.
- **Transition out, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** Also referred to as *ex-sex*. Former romantic partners who are no longer an official couple but continue or resume their sex relationship sometime after they break up.
- **True friends, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** Close friends who add sex to their friendship but don't consider themselves a couple even though they care about each other as friends.
- **Trust violations:** When a person behaves in a way that is deceptive or violates relational rules.
- **Truth bias:** The expectation that others will be honest.
- **Turning point analysis:** A method for plotting turning points on a graph to see how various events are related to changes in a relationship.
- **Unattended behavior:** A behavior (such as a blink) that goes unnoticed by either the sender or the receiver. (This is considered behavior but not communication.)
- **Uncertainty:** The level of confidence a person has in her or his ability to predict particular attitudes, behaviors, or outcomes. High uncertainty equates to being unconfident in one's ability to make those predictions whereas low uncertainty equates to being confident in one's ability to make those predictions.
- **Uncertainty management theory:** A theory based on the idea that uncertainty is neither inherently positive nor inherently negative but something that is managed (vs. *uncertainty reduction theory*).
- **Uncertainty reduction theory:** A theory based on the idea that uncertainty is generally negative and that the driving force in initial encounters is obtaining information about the other person in order to reduce uncertainty about her or him (vs. *uncertainty management theory*).
- **Underbenefited:** The state of getting a worse deal than your partner in terms of receiving fewer benefits, making more contributions, or both, so that the ratio of benefits to contributions favors your partner instead of you.
- **Understatements:** A form of deception that involves downplaying aspects of the truth.
- **Unintentional transition in, as a type of friends-with-benefits relationship:** When partners intend to keep the relationship as friends with benefits but end up getting emotionally attached and become a couple.
- **Unique interaction patterns:** Communicating in ways that reflect a relationship's special history, including shared experiences, inside jokes, and knowledge of private information. Unique interaction patterns help differentiate interpersonal (and close) relationships from role relationships.
- **Unrequited love:** A situation involving a would-be lover who wants to initiate or intensify a romantic relationship and a rejecter who does not.
- **Valence:** Positive or negative feelings or attitudes about messages, people, or relationships.
- **Veracity:** As a dimension of disclosure, this refers to how truthful the information is that someone is disclosing.

- **Verbal aggressiveness:** A style that focuses on attacking the other person's self-concept, often with the intention of hurting the other person. Verbally aggressive people engage in such tactics as teasing, threatening, and criticizing the partner's character or appearance.
- **Verbal immediacy:** Features of language that reflect the closeness of a relationship, including word choice, forms of address, depth of disclosure, and relationship indicators.
- **Verbal self-handicapping:** People will sometimes offer an excuse that serves to minimize the face threat of a potentially poor performance.
- **Viability:** Evolutionary needs related to the motivation to survive.
- **Violent communication, as a communicative response to jealousy:** Threats and actual violence, such as hitting, shoving, or threatening harm that occur in response to jealousy.
- **Virtual relationships:** Partners who have communicated and connected only online.
- **Vision of self:** A person's theory of self, made up of self-esteem and identity.
- **Visual centrality:** People who are perceived as powerful are also looked at more by others due to their interpersonal or physical position.
- **Visual dominance ratio:** A function of the time spent looking while speaking divided by the time spent looking while listening.
- **Vocalic behavior:** See *vocalics*.
- **Vocalics:** Also called *vocalic behavior*, nonverbal paralinguistic communication including silence and the way we say words, including vocal pitch, loudness, accent, tone, and speed, as well as vocalizations such as crying and sighing.
- **Voice, as a coping strategy:** Behaviors that are direct and constructive, such as talking about problems.
- **Whole-family secrets:** Confidences held by the entire family and kept from outsiders.
- **Wings:** Part of Goffman's dramaturgical perspective, the backstage and surrounding area where we can let our guard down and do not have to think about staying in character.
- **Withdrawal:** People avoid and give partners the silent treatment, ignore them, or limit communication with them. This is also known as *avoidance* or *distancing*.
- **Yielding:** An indirect and cooperative conflict style that involves one partner giving into and accommodating the other partner.